

COACH'S DRILL CARD

 EXCELLENT
 GOOD

	Timing	Stroke Length: Short/Long	Skiing at the Catch	Set on the Recovery	Set at the Finish	Set at the Catch	Set on the Drive	Ratio/Rushed Recovery	Hands Away: Slow/Fast	Grip	Finish: Weak	Finish: Washing Out	Finish: Timing	Drive: Slow Acceleration	Catch Timing: Early/Late	Catches: Missed Water	Bladework: Sq./Feather	Blade Height or Depth	Body Slouch/Weak Core	Body Rotation Inadequate	Body Preparation/Control	Arm Break too Early
1/4 or 1/2 Slide Rowing																						
2-Part Pause																						
Alternate Sq./Feather																						
Air Rows																						
Blade on the Water																						
Burried Backdowns																						
Catch Placement																						
Chops at Catch																						
Chops at Finish																						
Cut the Cake																						
Double Catch																						
Exaggerated Layback																						
Eyes Closed																						
Feet Out																						
Finish to Catch																						
Five and Glide																						
Freefall Drill																						
Gunwale Tap																						
Half Blade Depth																						
Inside Arm Only																						
Juggling																						
Long and Strong																						
Narrow Grip Rowing																						
One Finger Rowing																						
Outside Arm Only																						
Pairs Add In																						
Partial Feather																						
Pause Drill																						
Pause at Arms Away																						
Pause at Catch																						
Pause at 1/2 Slide																						
Pause at Release																						
Pick Drill & Reverse Pick																						
Pressure Build																						

RowSource.com	WHAT & HOW	WHY
1/4 or 1/2 Slide Rowing	After release and body prep, recover legs to 1/4 or 1/2 of the slide	Emphasize body prep, slide control, quick catch, engage legs before body
2-Part Pause	Pause at finish then hands, hands then body, OR body then 1/2 slide	Emphasize body prep/control/timing, ratio, slide control
Alternate Sq./Feather	1-10 strokes ea. on square then on feather, repeat	Concentrate on handle control, blade height, hull set
Air Rows	Row 3 regular strokes, then 1 stroke with blades in air through drive, finish & recovery. Repeat.	Emphasize set through entire stroke, maintain steady handle levels
Buried Backdowns	From 1/2 slide w/blades buried, move to full compression by pushing blade to the catch in water. Pause at catch, drive, let it run. Reset/repeat.	Heighten awareness of connection at catch, acceleration first half of drive
Catch Placement	Stationary: Work from 3/4 slide w/blades feathered on water > catch.	Emphasize tap down, hands away, sq. together, handle control, timing
Chops at Catch/ Finish	Sit squared & buried. Tap handle to clear blade over water > drop it in.	Fine tune timing. Light pressure on handle to release and catch blade.
Cut the Cake	From the finish, take "air stroke" of extra arms & body, then continue	Focus on set at finish, quick hands out of bow, handle control
Double Catch	On the move, or stationary: Catch > chop > catch and drive	Relax hands, use arm/shoulder as lever. Promote early sq., catch timing
Extra Layback	At low rate, add layback until rowers feel core muscles engage. Gradually back off until rowing normally.	Emphasize swing from hips into bow, swing together into stern
Eyes Closed	Row with eyes closed	Develop boat feel. Listen to the boat for non-visual timing cues.
Feet Out	Place feet on top of shoes and row	Connect w/foot stretcher and engage core through finish. Balance.
Finish to Catch	Stationary: Start at finish w/blade sq. & buried. On "row" move through stroke to catch and drop in the blade, don't drive. Reset at finish.	Reinforce following stroke. Timing. Catch placement. Slide control.
Five and Glide	From a stop: 5 full strokes > handles to gunwales OR let it run at hands away	Develop boat feel; promotes understanding of run and impact of set on run. Also good for practicing sprint race starts.
Freefall Drill	Alternate 1/4 slide and full slide strokes	Quick catches. Eliminate shooting slide. Control rush/ratio.
Gunwale Taps	At ~3/4 slide, sq. blade & push handle to gunwale. Carry handles at gunwale until last minute quick catch.	Use outside shoulder as lever. Aids in square-up & catch timing
Half Blade Depth	Row standard stroke but with blade only half buried in the water	Help novices learn correct handle levels, and minimize digging
Inside Arm Only	Rest outside arm behind back, row on the feather w/inside hand only	Strong/clean release, feather w/inside hand only. Flat wrist during drive.
Juggling	Drive w/outside hand, feather w/inside hand. Release grip of hand not in use. Smooth transitions.	Reinforce different roles of inside/outside hands. Promote correct grip, wrist and elbow positions.
Long and Strong	Row full pressure, bring rating as low as possible	Connect at catch, acceleration of knees to deck. Patience/set on recovery
Narrow Grip Rowing	Place hands close together at end of handle and row as usual	Improve handle control
One Finger Rowing	Light pressure. Start w/index finger. Add a finger every few strokes.	Promote light grip on handle. Focus on legs at catch/through drive.
Outside Arm Only	Rest inside arm behind back, row square w/outside hand only	Control blade height. Unweight handle to catch. "Hang" at catch.
Pairs Add In	Begin w/1 pair, add in 1 pair every 10 strokes 'til all 8 rowing	Teach novices to add in. Connect, accelerate, feel individual impact on run
Partial Feather	Release square > feather 25-50% > re-square b/w knees & ankles	Promote clean releases, blade control, and timing
Pause Drills	10 strokes ea. of pause at finish, hands away, body over, 1/2 slide	Timing. Collecting the crew at each segment of the stroke.
Pause at Arms Away	Row on square or feather, pause at arms away	Quick hands away. Bodies over prep/control/timing out of pause.
Pause at 1/2 Slide	Build boat speed, then pause at 1/2 slide	Quick hands. Body prep. Square up timing. Control second 1/2 of slide.
Pause at Release	Row on the square, pause at the release with focus on timing	Clean releases (prevent washing out/feathering underwater). Strong core.
Pick Drill	10-20 strokes ea. of arms > arms + body > 1/2 slide > full slide	Standard warm up. Isolates parts of stroke. Body prep out of bow.
Pressure Build	5 strokes: 1 ea. @ paddle, 50%, 75%, 90%, 100% pressure	Allow for controlled build into practice pieces and race starts
Reverse Pick Drill	10-20 strokes ea. of full slide legs only > 1/2 slide legs only > arms + body > arms	Warm up. Isolates parts of stroke. For advanced focus on engaging legs.
Russians	1 stroke ea. arms > arms + body > 1/2 slide > full slide. Repeat.	Emphasize concentration and timing
Slaps	Row finish to catch feathered. At the catch, slap flat blade on the water.	Focus on set during the recovery, and catch timing
Square Blades	Row with square blades, no feathering	Challenging by all 8 to force balance, strong finishes, and timing
Square Finishes	Row normally, pop blade out square at finish. Wait to feather until arms are fully extended.	Clean releases (prevent washing out/feathering underwater)
Stairstep	20 strokes ea.: 75% 1st half of drive to paddle pressure 2nd half > 100% 1st half of drive to paddle pressure 2nd half > 100% pressure through entire drive.	Accelerate off the foot stretcher. Understand power application and power levels.
Stand Up, Sit Down	Start at catch, pry blade through water & "stand up" on footstretcher, getting butt off seat (aka \$5 Bill Drill - make room for imaginary \$5)	Reinforce horizontal drive, no digging blade. Acceleration & connection.
Straight Arms	Row standard stroke but without arms	Take catch w/legs. Prevents breaking arms & opening back early.
Top of Slide Rowing	From catch: row top 1/4 or 1/2 of the slide. 1 stroke at a time or continuous	Promote quick catches, timing, and posture
Wide Grip	Row standard stroke w/inside hand moved down the oar shaft	Lowers inside shoulder & relaxes inside arm. Posture & torso rotation.